INTRODUCTION TO WRITING ABSTRACTS.

✨ Games Intersectional RoundTable ✨

24.06.2025

WHAT IS AN ABSTRACT?

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Abstract is...

- An abstract is a concise summary of a project, paper, or presentation, outlining its main argument, methodology, and contribution. It is typically used to inform potential readers or reviewers about the relevance, scope, and focus of the work.

STRUCTURE OF AN ABSTRACT

🧠 Structure by Questions:

1. What is it about?
2. Why is it important?
3. How did you explore it?
4. What are your key findings or arguments?
5. What's the takeaway?

IMPORTANT TO CONSIDER

- 🎓 Different fields = different styles
- 🧾 Some events ask for just an abstract, others want a paper or prototype too
- 🧑‍🏫 You might need to include a bio, CV, or personal website
- 🏁 Always check: Who is the audience? What kind of event/venue is it?
- 💡 Try to show why your perspective or approach matters!

LET'S LOOK AT SOME EXAMPLES!

ABSTRACT EXAMPLES: COMPUTER SCIENCE

✨ "One Spell Fits All" :
💡 Emphasizes innovation & creativity
🧙‍♀️ Accessible tone with technical insight
🎯 Targets both academic & game dev audiences

This paper presents "One Spell Fits All", an AI-native game prototype where the player, playing as a witch, solves villagers' problems using magical conjurations. We show how, beyond being a standalone game, "One Spell Fits All" could serve as a research platform to explore several key areas in AI-driven and AI-native game design. These areas include AI creativity, user experience in predominantly AI-generated content, and the energy efficiency of locally running versus cloud-based AI models. By leveraging smaller, locally running generative AI models, including LLMs and diffusion models for image generation, the game dynamically generates and evaluates content without the need for external APIs or internet access, offering a sustainable and responsive gameplay experience. This paper explores the application of LLMs in narrative video games, outlines a game prototype's design and mechanics, and proposes future research opportunities that can be explored using the game as a platform.

🛡️ UAV Swarm Abstract:
🤖 Technical, precise, full of domain terms
📊 Emphasizes simulation, methods, and evaluation
🎯 Targets engineering & AI conferences (e.g., IEEE, AAAI)

Abstract:
The development of autonomous swarm behavior for UAV swarms has increased significantly in recent years. Many applications such as collective transport, exploration of unknown territory or target search and delivery benefit from the flexibility, scalability and robustness of the swarm approach. Besides new application possibilities, these characteristics might also be used for malicious or dangerous purposes like autonomous target-oriented attacks. To date, research is lacking intelligent countermeasures to intervene in attacking UAV swarms. Typical defense mechanisms employ attack-defense confrontation which increases the risk of collateral damage as drones might fall from the sky. Rather than creating a confrontation, we focus on developing countermeasures to intelligently mislead or delay attacks on a target. Therefore, we explore two multi-agent deep reinforcement learning strategies for defender UAVs to intervene in target-oriented attacks of intelligent UAV swarms. Both strategies are based on the Multi-Agent Deep Deterministic Policy Gradient (MADDPG) algorithm and aim at preventing or at least delaying attacks. Via simulations we model and evaluate the performance of both methods and compare it to a baseline approach.

ABSTRACT EXAMPLES: HCI, EMPIRICAL RESEARCH

CHI PLAY WiP

📊 Focuses on a specific research question with a clear empirical method

🧩 Defines the gap: unclear how motivations intersect with identities

🔧 Uses concise results language (e.g., "we found correlations...")

CHI PLAY WiP 2023: Game jams are events where development teams collaborate to create games in days or weeks, sharing common themes and limitations. However, it is unclear how participants in game jams fit into the larger gaming culture regarding their motivations and identities as gamers. Our paper surveys two game jam populations to determine their player motivation profiles using the Hexad-12 questionnaire, roles in the development teams at a game jam, their correspondence to the gamer and LGBTQ+ identity, and their play-time per week. The results show that the population in our samples does not differ significantly from the one reported in the original Hexad study. We found correlations between the Hexad player types and the development roles at a game jam. People interested in Game/Level Design and people reporting having fun as a reason for attending the game jam were more likely to be Achiever types, people interested in Art were more likely, while those interested in Programming were less likely to be Disruptor types, and the more participants identified as a gamer, the more likely they were Player types, and/or preferred the Game/Level Design role. Furthermore, we found that both samples identified to some extent with the term gamer. Additionally, the more participants leaned towards identifying as a gamer, the more likely they were Players and/or preferred the Game/Level Design hat.

🌍 GALA 2024

🛠️ Describes both the methodology and its broader purpose

🔁 Emphasizes community-centered approach and iterative development

GALA 2024: Forced migration due to conflict, ecological disasters, or persecution affects millions worldwide. This paper presents a participatory approach to serious game development aimed at enhancing empathy and awareness of forced migration experiences. Engaging individuals with lived experiences of forced migration at every stage of the game development process ensures the content is authentic and impactful. Using empirical findings from our qualitative research, we developed a preliminary game design methodology that guides the creation of narratives effectively conveying the complex realities of forced migration. Our study highlights the potential of participatory game development to bridge the gap between forced migrants and the broader public, creating a powerful educational experience that promotes empathy and social change. This paper introduces a methodology that integrates marginalized groups into their own storytelling, fostering empathy and awareness among a wider audience.

ABSTRACT EXAMPLES: GAME STUDIES

📍 Opens with a focused context: trauma-aware game design
🔍 Identifies a gap: lack of dynamic emotional storytelling tools
🛠️ Lists key methods: autoethnography, prototyping, design framework
🌱 Concludes with intention: creating space for catharsis and empowerment

Traces of Memory, Traces of Home: Trauma-Aware Environmental Storytelling in Games

This presentation explores how game environments can function as emotional architectures, spaces that do not just represent trauma, but embody it. In particular, I examine how digital environments can reflect fractured relationships to memory, identity, and home. I propose a twofold approach: a critical reading of trauma in environmental storytelling, and a participatory design method grounded in co-creation and lived experience.

First, I examine how games such as Silent Hill 2 use space to externalize grief, memory, and emotional fragmentation. These environments are not just settings, they are structured by loss. They invite players to navigate emotional landscapes through movement and embodiment, instead of exposition.

Second, I reflect on my research-creation work with people who have experienced forced migration, in which we co-design adaptive environments that shift in response to memory, emotion, and identity. I would like to introduce a dual-role framework: Survivors, who shape and embed memory traces into environments; and Witnesses, who explore these spaces with limited agency. This distinction reflects different relationships to trauma: those who have lived it, and those invited to listen. This model invites reflection on authorship, the emotional labor of sharing trauma, and the ethics of game design. It also challenges dominant design assumptions, suggesting that withholding agency can be a powerful act of care.

This work argues that trauma-aware environmental storytelling offers a way to reimagine home, not as a static setting, but as a shifting, layered space where pain and longing coexist.

Ultimately, this approach makes space for grief and displacement not just thematically, but architecturally. What remains are not just spaces, but traces, of memory, of home, of stories that ask us to listen more deeply to others, and to the pasts we carry with us.

🎯 Starts with research question
🧠 Connects theory (postcolonialism, authoritarianism) with specific game examples
🎁 Ends with a clear contribution: what the talk offers and why it matters

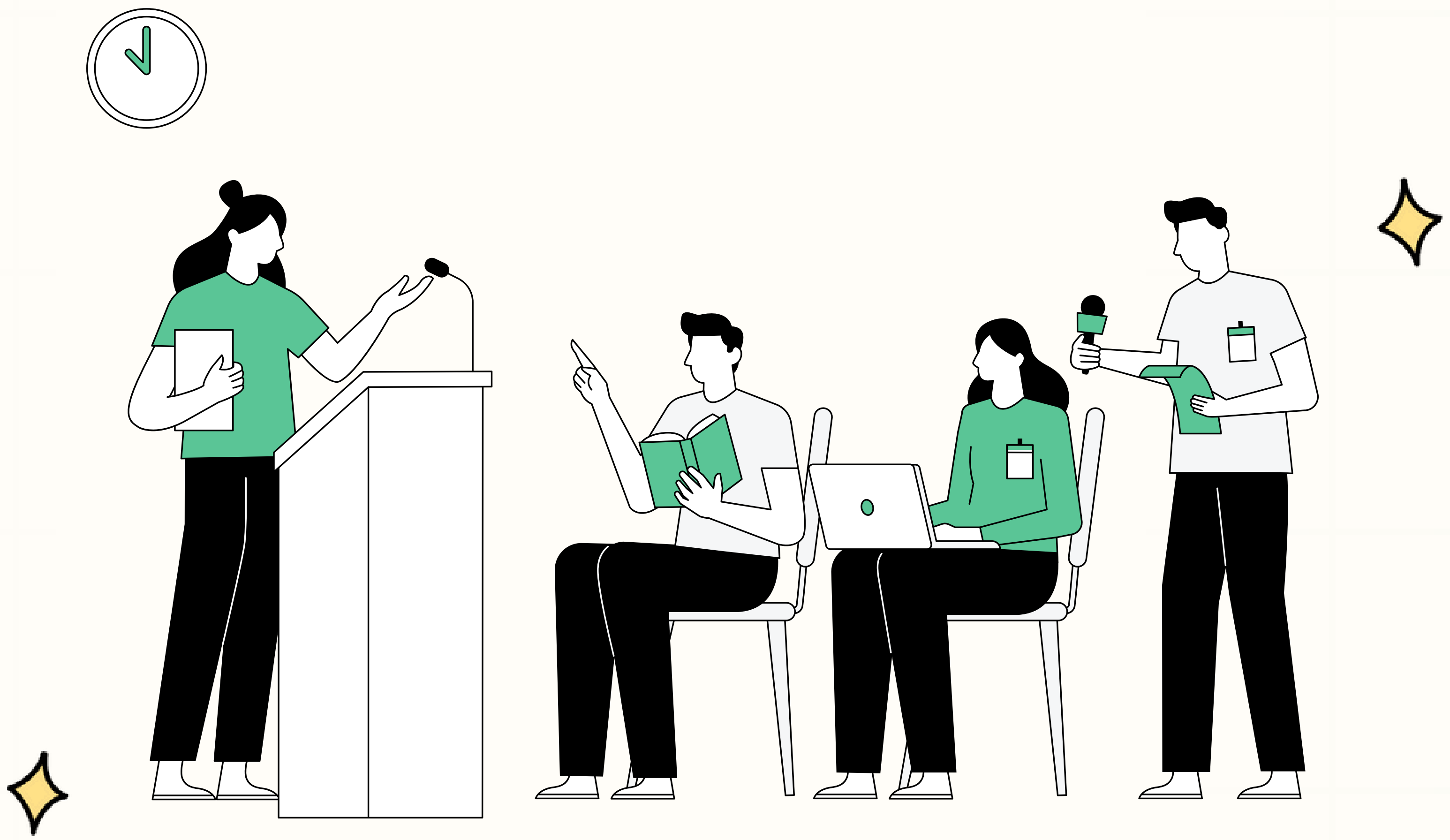
In the current landscape of video games, the portrayal of historical and political themes has become increasingly influential. This paper explores the subtle ways in which popular games, such as "The Battle of Polytopia," "Root," "Lil' Guardsman," and "Stray" normalize and, in some cases, romanticize the narratives of colonialism, imperialism, and authoritarianism. These games offer a unique lens to examine how contemporary digital media recreates and reinterprets historical power dynamics.

"The Battle of Polytopia" presents a simplified, mobile strategy experience where players expand their empires through conquest and development, cloaked in minimalist aesthetics. This juxtaposition of 'cute' graphics with themes of domination and expansion raises questions about the trivialization of colonial undertones. "Root," a board game with a digital adaptation, uses anthropomorphic woodland creatures to allegorically represent various forms of governance and resistance. The game's portrayal of territorial control and factional conflict offers rich ground for analyzing metaphorical representations of imperialism. "Lil' Guardsman" contributes to these themes by simulating the authoritarian border control mechanics of "Papers, Please" within a fantasy cartoon world. Finally, "Stray" offers a post-apocalyptic perspective of an adventure game where players control a cute stray cat navigating a decaying city inhabited by robots, exploring themes of survival and societal collapse.

Utilizing an interdisciplinary approach, this paper employs theories from cultural studies and game studies to dissect game mechanics, narrative elements, and aesthetic choices. The aim is to uncover how these games reflect, distort, or confront historical narratives of colonization and empire-building.

This research contributes to the broader conversation about the role of video games as media of ideology, particularly in how they shape our perceptions of historical and contemporary socio-political issues. It underscores the need for critical engagement with video games as they increasingly become a part of our cultural and educational fabric, influencing views on history, politics, and identity.

Q&A



LET'S LOOK AT A SUBMISSION PAGE!

BRAINSTORM TIME

WRITING TIME

THANK YOU